

JULY 2, 1976

North and South Vietnam are formally unified as the Socialist Republic of Vietnam under hardline communist rule.



Stamp commemorating the first national assembly after Vietnam's reunification

APRIL 30, 1977

Kampuchea launches a border attack against Vietnam. Sporadic border fighting between the two countries continues into 1978.

SEPTEMBER 1978

Large numbers of people begin fleeing Vietnam by sea, and are dubbed the Boat People.

DECEMBER 25, 1978

The Vietnamese Army launches a full-scale invasion of Kampuchea in association with Cambodian rebels.

JANUARY 7, 1979

Vietnamese forces occupy Phnom Penh and overthrow the Pol Pot regime, installing a new government under Heng Samrin.

FEBRUARY 17, 1979

China launches a punitive offensive into northern Vietnam, in response to the Vietnamese invasion of Cambodia.

MARCH 16, 1979

Chinese troops complete a withdrawal from northern Vietnam, claiming their mission has been successfully completed. The Vietnamese claim to have repulsed the Chinese invasion.

JUNE 1979

The Boat People exodus peaks, with 54,000 refugees fleeing Vietnam in a month.